



Sam Altman

Chief Executive Officer

2015

Founded

\$40B+

Run rate (Aug 2026)

\$852B

Valuation (Mar 2026)

~92%

Fortune 500 using ChatGPT

\$20.9B

2025 operating loss

01 Who You're Meeting

Sam Altman — Chief Executive Officer, OpenAI.

In role: Co-founded OpenAI in 2015; CEO since 2019, apart from a brief removal and reinstatement in November 2023

Today: Leads OpenAI through its transition from research lab to public company — the October 2025 recapitalisation into OpenAI Group PBC, the March 2026 funding round at \$852B, and a confidential S-1 filed in June 2026.

A startup operator turned platform CEO. He was President of Y Combinator, the accelerator, before OpenAI, and earlier co-founded the location-based startup Loopt. He co-founded OpenAI in 2015 as a non-profit research lab and became CEO in 2019 as it restructured to raise commercial capital. In November 2023 the board removed him and reinstated him within days after an employee revolt — an episode that reshaped OpenAI's governance and remains the reference point for questions about board control. He is reported to hold no equity in the company.

Career: Chief Executive Officer, OpenAI; Co-Founder, OpenAI; President, Y Combinator; Co-Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Loopt

The company: The most broadly adopted AI product in the enterprise — roughly 92% of the Fortune 500 use ChatGPT and business customers passed one million in November 2025 — while carrying losses large enough that the IPO timetable has slipped from a 2026 listing toward 2027.

What they sell: ChatGPT across free, Plus (\$20/month) and Pro (\$200/month) tiers, enterprise plans, and the API and developer platform. An advertising pilot was added during 2026.

02 Where The Company Sits

For a portfolio programme, OpenAI's advantage is penetration: the product is already inside most organisations, often through individual and team subscriptions before IT gets involved, which makes governance rather than procurement the first problem to solve. The strategic risk to watch is what a listing does to the product. A public company optimises for margin and for revenue-driving enterprise features; reporting suggests API-only customers may find themselves in a lower priority tier than large enterprise accounts.

03 Talking Points

- ChatGPT is already inside your PortCos, usually through unmanaged individual subscriptions. The conversation is governance and consolidation, not selection.
- A pending listing changes his incentives. Expect enterprise accounts to be prioritised over API-only customers, and plan portability accordingly.
- The November 2023 board episode is why governance questions about OpenAI are legitimate rather than impertinent.

What to pressure-test about the company:

- Leaked audited 2025 figures show \$13.1B of booked revenue against a \$20.9B operating loss — the run-rate numbers and the audited numbers are very different things
- Projected cash burn of roughly \$27B in 2026 and ~\$63B in 2027
- One analyst framing of the valuation is that it prices a monopoly outcome that does not yet exist

04 GIP Context

GIP: No publicly disclosed GIP relationship. ChatGPT is near-certain to be present across PortCos already, frequently through unmanaged individual subscriptions — which makes this a governance and consolidation question rather than a vendor selection one.

BlackRock: No publicly disclosed operating relationship. OpenAI is private; the March 2026 round was led by SoftBank and Microsoft.

Others at OpenAI: Sarah Friar (Chief Financial Officer)

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